Chenyu Bu

Curriculum Vitae | *September 2026*

Department of Philosophy
The University of Texas, Austin
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Education

The University of Texas at Austin 2021 – 2027
Ph.D. in Philosophy (ABD) *expected*
Dissertation: *Objects, Structures, and Abstraction*
Committee: Kathleen Higgins (co-chair), Jon Litland (co-chair), Robbie Kubala, Josh Dever, James Buhler (Music)

University of Wisconsin–Madison 2017 – 2021
B.A. in Philosophy, Music Composition, Mathematics, *with Honors*

Research Areas

AOS: Metaphysics, Aesthetics
AOC: Philosophy of Mathematics, Philosophy of Language, Philosophy of Logic

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Music without Works: A Case for Compositional Ontology 2026
The Philosophical Quarterly (forthcoming).

Schopenhauerian Musical Formalism: Meaningfulness without Meaning 2023
Journal of Comparative Literature and Aesthetics **46** (4), 70–79.

Book Reviews

Daniel Albright, *Music's Monisms: Disarticulating Modernism* (2022) 2025
The British Journal of Aesthetics, **65** (4), 691-695

Tristan Grøtvedt Haze, *Meaning and Metaphysical Necessity* (2022) 2023
Review of Metaphysics 77 (2), 351-353.

Works in Progress

Under Review

A paper on musical formalism, movement, and meaning

In Preparation

A paper developing a general theory of generativism
A paper arguing for a top-down structuralist approach to essences
A paper presenting and defending a trifold (platonist) musical ontology
A paper on symmetries, abstraction, and identification of objects
A paper on the nature of aesthetic form

Collaborative Projects

Generative Ecologies: Tweaks, Leaps, and Blocks
Enacted Metaphor and Tacit Knowledge Transmission

Selected Talks

Conference Presentations (⋆ = peer-reviewed; † = invited)

Yoneda Essence and Structural Identity
Defining the Formal Foundations of Intelligences,† Bloomington, IN — May 2026

Generating Structures: An Essentialist Account
2026 Henle Conference on Essentialism,⋆ St. Louis, MO — March 2026

How to Stop Worrying and Embrace Musical Platonism
American Society for Aesthetics (ASA) Pacific Meeting,⋆ Berkeley, CA — March 2026
American Philosophical Association (APA) Pacific Meeting,⋆ [virtual] — April 2026

Beyond the Given: Toward a General Theory of Generativism
APA Central Meeting,⋆ Chicago, IL — February 2026

Toward a General Theory of Generativism
Metaphysical Mayhem,⋆ New Brunswick, NJ — May 2025

Doing Away with Works: Let's Talk About *Music*
APA Central Meeting⋆ [virtual] — February 2025

Abstract Object and Platonic Inheritance
APA Eastern Meeting, New York, NY — January 2025

Cohesion, Clarity, Closure: How Music Navigates the Wake of Tragedy
Performance Philosophy Biennial Conference,⋆ Austin, TX — May 2024

Musical Formalism Reconsidered: A Category-Theoretic Approach
ASA Eastern Meeting,⋆ Philadelphia, PA — April 2024

Music as Meaningfulness Without Meaning: A Schopenhauerian Account
Jahrestagung der Schopenhauer-Forschungsstelle⋆ [virtual] — November 2023
UT-Austin Graduate Colloquia Series, Austin, TX — September 2022

In Defense of a Real Musical Platonism
ASA Rocky Mountain Meeting,⋆ Santa Fe, NM — July 2023

An Inferentialist Account of *I*
Society for Philosophy in the Contemporary World Annual Meeting,⋆ Fresno, CA — July 2023

A Kantian Approach to Perception as Predictive Processing
University of Bucharest Graduate Conference,⋆ [virtual] — June 2022

Sound, Silence, and Sartrean Nothingness
Boston College Dianoia Publication Symposium† [virtual] — July 2020

Commentaries

Andrew Kania, "Justifying and Advancing the Explication of the Musical-Cover Concept," † *ASA 83rd Annual Meeting*, Baltimore, MD — October 2025

Matthew Shields, "The Impossibility of Conceptual Abandonment," †
APA Central Meeting [virtual] — February 2025

Minseok Kim, "Way-Nominalism: An Ontological Ground for Non-Nominal Quantification," † *APA Central Meeting*, New Orleans, LA — February 2024

Academic Awards

American Society for Aesthetics Dissertation Fellowship	2026-27
Dean's Prestigious Supplement Fellowship, UT Austin	2026-27
Fellow, Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute	2026
University Graduate Continuing Fellowship, UT Austin	2025-26
Humanities Research Awards, The Humanities Institute	2025-26
Graduate Student Assembly Travel Award, UT Austin	2025
Billy Bob Draeger Graduate Research Fellowship in the Humanities	2024-25
Summer Graduate Fellowship, UT Austin	2024
Professional Development Awards (*8), UT Austin	2023, 2024
Irene H. Chayes Travel Grants (*3), ASA	2023, 2024, 2026
Best Graduate Student Essay Prize, Center for Philosophical Studies	2023
Summer Research Funds (*2), UT Graduate Studies	2023, 2024
Top Paper of *Logos* Volume XVI, Cornell University	2020

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record at University of Texas at Austin

Philosophy and Film	Spring 2025
Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts	Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant at University of Texas at Austin

Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts (Matthew Bisconti)	Spring 2024
Intermediate Symbolic Logic (Joshua Dever)	Fall 2023
Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts (Kathleen Higgins)	Spring 2023
Problems of Knowledge and Valuation (Mark Sainsbury)	Fall 2022
Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts (Alicia Armijo)	Spring 2022
Philosophy of Law (Jeffrey Leon)	Summer 2022
Ideas of the Twentieth Century (Daniel Bonevac)	Fall 2021

Pedagogical Training at University of Texas at Austin

Supervised Teaching in Philosophy (Michael Tye)	Spring 2024
Teaching Preparation Series (The Center for Teaching and Learning)	2021–22

Selected Coursework

Graduate Seminars at University of Texas at Austin

AI, Language, and Mind (with Kyle Mahowald and Daniel Drucker)	Fall 2026
Philosophy of Language (with Josh Dever and Ray Buchanan)	Spring 2026
Higher-Order Metaphysics (with Jon Litland and Harvey Lederman)	Fall 2025
Issues in Philosophy of Music (with Kathleen Higgins)	Spring 2024
Plenitude and Generation (with Jon Litland)	Fall 2023
Artworks and Persons (with Robbie Kubala)	Fall 2023
MSDRT Model Theory (with Hans Kamp)	Summer 2023
Formal Epistemology (with Harvey Lederman)	Spring 2023
Theories of Meaning (with Joshua Dever)	Spring 2023
Kant's *Critique of Pure Reason* (with Ian Proops)	Spring 2023
Logic and Inferentialism (with Jon Litland and Sinan Dogramaci)	Fall 2022
De Se and the Self (with Joshua Dever and Miriam Schoenfield)	Fall 2022

Perception and Action (with Galen Strawson) Spring 2022
Aesthetics (with Kathleen Higgins) Fall 2021
Metaethics and Aesthetics (with Karl Schafer and Robbie Kubala) Fall 2021

Conference Courses at University of Texas at Austin

Musical Structuralism and Category Theory (with Jon Litland) Fall 2023
Music and Meaning (with Kathleen Higgins) Spring 2023

Undergraduate Seminars at University of Wisconsin-Madison

Music, Capitalism, and Speculative Future (with Nadia Chana) Spring 2021
Renaissance Polyphony (with Leslie Blasius) Spring 2021
Orchestration (with Laura Schwendinger) Spring 2021
Form and Analysis (with Leslie Blasius) Spring-Fall 2020
Schopenhauer and Nietzsche (with James Messina) Spring 2020
Existentialism (with Henry Southgate) Fall 2019

Professional Service

Referee 2026
The British Journal of Aesthetics, *Estetika: The European Journal of Aesthetics*

Program Committee 2022 – 2023
Faculty Colloquium at University of Texas at Austin

Conference Organizer, Peer Reviewer 2023
Graduate Conference at University of Texas at Austin

Professional Affiliations

American Society for Aesthetics 2023 – Present
American Philosophical Association 2023 – Present

Languages

Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

References

Kathleen M. Higgins
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